Physics 116 Lab, Fall 2025
Policies and Information

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Office: MSC W205B
Office Hours: By appointment
Labs Begin: **Monday September 15th**

Welcome to Introductory Astronomy Lab! We hope that you will find the labs both educational and enjoyable, and that they will help you develop an appreciation for the night sky. Lab is designed with two goals in mind: the first is that you will become acquainted with some of the scientific methods that astronomers use to determine the nature of our universe. Astronomy is applied physics, and we hope to show you how astronomers use physics to better understand the universe. Second is that you will develop skills in finding your way around the night sky, including learning the brighter stars and constellations.

General Information

- Physics 116: Introduction to Astronomy is a fully in-person course. Some asynchronous material will be posted each week to your lab Canvas page, introducing the material we will be covering in the next lab. However, all labs must be completed during the regular class session. You may not begin labs before coming to class, and you will not be given time to finish them after class has ended.
- ***You are required to attend all lab sessions***. It is your responsibility to make sure you are able to attend the section you have registered for. You will not be permitted to attend a different lab section without prior approval from your instructor.
- ***The lab Canvas page is not the same as the lecture Canvas page***. Each lab section has a different Canvas page, and all lab information, resources, and the labs themselves will be posted there. It is expected that you will check Canvas frequently to make sure you have all the necessary information to prepare for and complete the labs.

Course Materials – You will need to purchase a Planisphere for lab, which is available from the bookstore. Please make sure you have it for the first day of class.

Lab Handouts – Most, *but not all,* labs may be completed electronically and submitted through Canvas. If you prefer not to complete the lab electronically, you *must bring a full size print out of the lab to class*. Hardcopies of the lab handout will NOT be provided.

> ***NOTE****:* some labs may not be completed electronically, for example when we are outside or using the Planetarium, so all students will need to bring a full-size printout of the lab to complete by hand.

Computers – many of the labs will require a computer. I encourage you to bring your own laptop to use in class, however we do have computers available in the lab room. NOTE: if you

choose to use your own laptop you will need to make sure you have several software packages installed. Information on the required software can be found on your lab Canvas page.

Labs - Collaboration is an important part of doing science, so you will be asked to work in groups of 2-3. An Introduction to the week's lab will be posted to Canvas in advance of each lab, so please read through it before class and watch any posted videos. The lab for each week will be posted to Canvas before class to give you a chance to read it, but you *should not* begin working on it before class. You should work on all parts of the lab with your group, however, please keep in mind that you must each turn in your own version of the lab and it must be your own work, in your own words.

Quizzes – There will be some unannounced pre- and post-lab quizzes given throughout the semester. Some of the quizzes will be given at the beginning of class, and others will be given on Canvas to be completed outside of class time. In those instances, you will be given a 48-hour window in which to complete the quiz. The quizzes are intended to check your preparation for that day's labs, as well as your understanding of the basic concepts covered in previous classes (including knowledge of stars and constellations). Those who are absent or late to class are not given additional time to complete a quiz. Missed quizzes cannot be made up unless your instructor grants approval to do so before the submission deadline.

Accessibility and Accommodations: The Department of Accessibility Services (DAS) works with students who have disabilities to provide reasonable accommodations. It is your responsibility to request accommodations and contact your instructor as early as possible in the semester to discuss the plan for implementation of your accommodations. In order to receive consideration for reasonable accommodations, you must register with the DAS at https://accessibility.emory.edu/ . Accommodations cannot be retroactively applied, so it is important that you contact DAS as early in the semester as possible.

For additional information about accessibility and accommodations, please contact the Department of Accessibility Services at (404) 727-9877 or accessibility@emory.edu.

Attendance:

- ***Attendance is mandatory.*** You will not receive credit for a lab if you do not attend your regular lab session, unless you have been given permission by your instructor.

- ***Three lab absences will result in automatic failure of the Astronomy course***, regardless of other grades. While lab only accounts for 20% of your overall grade, it is not possible to pass the Astronomy course if you miss more than two labs.

- ***There are no make-up labs for unexcused absences.*** If you have an unavoidable conflict that results in an unexcused absence, then that lab will count as a zero in your final grade calculation. Notify your lab instructor in advance if you are going to miss a lab, and provide any documentation that may excuse the absence. An excused absence permits you to make up the lab, it DOES NOT excuse you from doing the lab entirely.

- ***Please arrive to lab on time.*** Arriving late will result in a grade penalty for the lab.

Grading:
It is department policy that you must pass Lab to pass the Astronomy course. No grades of 'incomplete' will be given for the labs. Grading will consist of the following:

- ***80% Lab Reports***. Graded for accuracy, completeness, thoroughness, following directions, neatness, and effort. If a lab report falls within the normal range for the above criteria, it will receive a grade of 90. A small number of lab reports that are exceptionally better than the norm may receive a higher grade, but in order to do that the work must exceed the expectation of what is asked and required in the lab. A lab report that is lacking in completeness, effort, following directions, or accuracy will receive a grade lower than 90. ***The lowest grade will be dropped in the final grade calculation.***

- ***10% Quizzes***

- ***10% Attendance and Participation***. Things considered include, but are not limited to, class attendance, attitude, effort, overall quality of work, level of participation in group work, preparation for class, and being on time.

Honor Code
You will work with other students in completing the labs, but the lab report you turn in must be your own work. Written answers that are identical to those of another student, in full or in part, are considered a violation of the Honor Code. Similarly, possession of lab reports done by others is considered a violation of the honor code, as is passing on a completed lab report to another student. Quizzes are not done with partners unless otherwise specified by the instructor, and must be your own work.

Statement from Dr. Batiste and the Department of Physics
The purpose of this class is to learn astronomy. Please treat your classmates with respect both in and out of the classroom. In particular, it is unacceptable to judge your fellow students by gender, race, or any other irrelevant factor. If you have any concerns, please talk with me or the department chair, Prof. Connie Roth.

Schedule
Lab begins after the end of A/D/S, on the week of September 15th. The lab for a given week will be posted 1-2 days in advance, so that you have time to read/watch the introductory material and look over the lab (you may *not* begin working on the lab). There is no lab during breaks, so **there will be no lab sessions the week of October 13th (Fall Break) or the week of November 24th (Thanksgiving).** The final lab will be one of *either* an observing lab that you do at an observing session one night during the semester, or a take-home observing lab during the last week of classes.